REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT IN FAVOR O MEASURE H

Measure H raises Solano County's Transient Occupancy Tax (TOT) on overnight stays from 5% to 12%, a 140% increase. Supporters claim this is simply a "reasonable" adjustment because nearby jurisdictions charge more, but matching higher rates is not a public justification, it is still a tax increase on visitors and the lodging businesses that serve them.

The "additional revenue" figure cited ($58,000 annually) is small amount in comparison to the big jump in the tax rate. A 12% TOT can increase total lodging costs enough to reduce bookings, especially for price-sensitive travelers. That means revenue projections may be optimistic and the real economic impact could fall on local jobs and occupancy.

Measure H also rests on the promise that all funds "stay local" and cannot be taken by the State or Federal governments. Even if those dollars remain within County control, raising taxes does not guarantee the County will protect specific services or maintain spending levels; it only changes who pays more and when.

Finally, two supervisors signed the "favor" argument, but signatures do not answer the key question: whether a nearly doubling of the TOT is the best, most targeted way to fund essential services. Solano should pursue transparent, budget-specific solutions rather than imposing a steep, economy-sensitive tax increase on travelers.

VOTE NO ON MEASURE H.

Solano County Taxpayers Association
s/Michael T Nolan, President

s/ Shari Borkin
Dixon resident